



**RANVEER BRAR**
*Celebrity chef-author*

**"THE BIGGEST SECRET TO BEING HAPPY IS TO HAVE THE MEMORY OF A GOLD FISH. FORGET WHAT HAPPENED YESTERDAY AND LIVE IN THE MOMENT"**

**JOHNY LEVER**
*Comic legend*

**"I APPROACH ALL MY FILMS AS IF IT IS MY FIRST FILM. I NEVER TAKE COMEDY LIGHTLY. I TRY AND IMPROVE MY CRAFT EVERY DAY AND MAKE IT BETTER"**

**KUNAL KEMMU**
*Actor*

**"YOU NEED TO BE HAPPY WITHIN TO BE ABLE TO RADIATE HAPPINESS. TRY TO MAKE SOMEONE SMILE, YOU'LL AUTOMATICALLY FEEL HAPPIER"**

next got the laughs going with his observational humour.

The highlight of the evening was the INDIA TODAY-RPG Happiness Awards. To shortlist the categories and nominees, INDIA TODAY had engaged the research agency MDRA. It researched each nominee's contribution thoroughly and conducted a perception survey across a dozen cities to shortlist five names under each of the categories. Jury members Aroon Purie, Chairman and Editor-in-Chief, India Today Group; Harsh Goenka, Chairman, RPG Group; Anant Goenka, Vice-Chairman, RPG Group; and Raj Chengappa, Group Editorial Director (Publishing), India Today Group, presented the trophies to the winners for bringing happiness and giving hope to people in these trying times.

The illustrious list included Alia Bhatt, who was awarded for the 'Most Inspiring Performance of the Year' in the movie *Gangubai Kathiawadi*, Ashish Chanchlani for being the 'Funniest YouTuber of the Year', and



**YAMI GAUTAM**
*Actor*

**"I TALK TO MY FAMILY DAILY—'WHAT WERE YOU DOING... WHAT WAS COOKED TODAY?' JUST TO KNOW THEY ARE ALRIGHT AND HAPPY MAKES ME HAPPY"**

Abhishek Banerjee for the 'Funniest Film Performance of the Year' in *Bhediya*. The Viral Fever team followed up its last year's win (for *Kota Factory*) with yet another for making the 'Most Inspirational OTT Series'—*Panchayat 2*. India Women's Cricket Captain Harmanpreet Kaur was adjudged the 'Most Inspiring Sportsperson of the Year' and Sadhguru Jaggi Vasudev the 'Most Positive Influencer'. Goa was the 'Happiest State' and Smile Foundation the 'NGO that Brought the Most Happiness'. And then there were two Special Jury Awards for the India Women's Hockey Team and actor Rishab Shetty (see *Why They Won*).

The evening concluded with the '*desi*' rock and roll group Faridkot bringing the audience to their feet with a setlist that included Amar Jalal singing their chartbuster 'Nasha' twice on special demand. There were smiles all around and a spring in everyone's step after the group's hour-long vibrant act—bringing to an end the Happiness Fest that surely lived up to its name. ■